



Homework Assignment

Week 4: String Basics

Total Points: 100 — Due: Next Class



Name: _____

Date: _____

Important Instructions

- Work on your own, but you may ask family members for hints only if stuck
- Write your code in Python (*using Thonny or any online IDE*)
- For setting up your code files, kindly see `instructions.pdf`
- For written answers, use the spaces provided on this sheet
- Show your work for full credit!

1 Part 1: String Tracing Practice (15 points)

Time estimate: 20 minutes

1.1 Exercise 1.1: Trace the String Operations (8 points)

For this part you are not supposed to run the code on computer. Read this code carefully and trace through each step, filling in the following table:

```
1 message = "Hello"
2 result = ""
3 for i in range(4):
4     result = result + message[i]
5     print(f"Step {i+1}: {result}")
```

Fill in the trace table below:

Iteration	i	message[i]	result becomes	What prints
1	0	'H'	"H"	
2				
3				
4				

1.2 Exercise 1.2: Predict the Output (7 points)

Without running the code, predict what this prints:

```
1 text = "PYTHON"
2 print(text[0] + text[-1])
3 print(text[1:4])
4 print(text.lower()[2])
5 print(len(text))
```

Your prediction:

Line 1 output: _____

Line 2 output: _____

Line 3 output: _____

Line 4 output: _____

Now run the code to check your prediction. Were you correct?

2 Part 2: Code Completion - String Operations (18 points)

Time estimate: 25 minutes

2.1 Exercise 2.1: Username Validator (10 points)

Open [week4_ex2_1.py](#) and complete the username validation program. This will help you practice string methods and indexing.

```
1 # Username Validator
2 print("=== Username Checker ===")
3 username = input("Enter your username: ")
4
5 # Check if username is valid length (between 3 and 12 characters)
6 length = _____
7 if length < 3:
8     print("Username too short! Must be at least 3 characters.")
9 elif length > 12:
10    print("Username too long! Maximum 12 characters.")
11 else:
12    print(f"Length OK: {length} characters")
13
14 # Check first character (must be a letter)
15 first_char = username[_____]
16 if first_char.isalpha():
17    print(f"Good! Username starts with letter '{_____}'")
18 else:
19    print(f"Error: Username must start with a letter, not '{_____}'")
20
21 # Check if username contains any spaces
22 if " " in _____:
23    print("Error: Username cannot contain spaces!")
```

```

24 else:
25     print("Good! No spaces found.")
26
27 # Display username in different formats
28 print("\nUsername formats:")
29 print(f"Uppercase: {_____}") # Use upper() method
30 print(f"Lowercase: {_____}") # Use lower() method
31 print(f"First 3 characters: {_____}") # Use slicing

```

2.2 Exercise 2.2: Password Strength Checker (8 points)

Open [week4_ex2.2.py](#) and complete the password strength checker. This will help you practice string methods and searching.

```

1  # Password Strength Checker
2  print("=== Password Strength Checker ===")
3  password = input("Enter a password to check: ")
4
5  strength_score = 0
6
7  # Check 1: Length (at least 8 characters)
8  if len(_____) >= 8:
9      strength_score = strength_score + 1
10     print("Good length")
11 else:
12     print("Too short (need 8+ characters)")
13
14 # Check 2: Contains uppercase letter
15 has_upper = False
16 for char in password:
17     if char._____: # Check if character is uppercase
18         has_upper = True
19         break
20 if has_upper:
21     strength_score = strength_score + 1
22     print("Has uppercase letter")
23 else:
24     print("Missing uppercase letter")
25
26 # Check 3: Contains number
27 has_digit = False
28 for char in password:
29     if char._____: # Check if character is a digit
30         has_digit = True
31         break
32 if has_digit:
33     strength_score = strength_score + 1
34     print("Has number")
35 else:
36     print("Missing number")
37
38 # Check 4: First and last characters are different
39 if password[_____] != password[_____]: # Compare first and last
40     strength_score = strength_score + 1
41     print("First and last characters differ")
42 else:
43     print("First and last characters are same")
44

```

```

45 # Display strength rating
46 print(f"\nStrength Score: {strength_score}/4")
47 if strength_score == 4:
48     print("STRONG password!")
49 elif strength_score >= 2:
50     print("MEDIUM password - could be stronger")
51 else:
52     print("WEAK password - please improve it")

```

3 Part 3: String Analysis and Comparison (15 points)

Time estimate: 20 minutes

3.1 Exercise 3.1: Compare String Operations (8 points)

Without running the code on a computer, study these three code snippets:

Code A:

```

1 word = "HELLO"
2 result = word[0:3]
3 print(result)

```

Code B:

```

1 word = "HELLO"
2 result = word[:3]
3 print(result)

```

Code C:

```

1 word = "HELLO"
2 result = word[-3:]
3 print(result)

```

Fill in what each code prints:

Code A prints:	Code B prints:	Code C prints:
_____	_____	_____

Which slicing pattern would you use to:

- Get the first 5 characters of a name? _____
- Get the last 4 characters of a phone number? _____
- Copy an entire string? _____

3.2 Exercise 3.2: Fix the Logic (7 points)

This program should capitalize only the first letter of each word, but it's not working correctly:

```

1 # Broken Title Formatter
2 text = "hello world python"
3 result = text.upper() # This makes everything uppercase!
4 print(result)

```

Current output: HELLO WORLD PYTHON

Desired output: Hello World Python

Open [week4_ex3.2.py](#) and fix the code by using the correct string method:

```

1 # Title Formatter
2 text = "hello world python"
3 result = _____() # Use the right method
4 print(result)
5
6 # Test with another example
7 name = "ahmed ali khan"
8 formatted_name = _____() # Same method
9 print(formatted_name)

```

4 Part 4: Problem Solving with Strings (18 points)

Time estimate: 25 minutes

4.1 Exercise 4.1: Message Encoder (18 points)

Scenario: Secret Message System

You're creating a simple message encoder that transforms text in special ways. The program should take a message and apply various transformations to create an encoded version.

Open [week4_ex4.1.py](#) and complete the message encoder program.

```

1 # Secret Message Encoder
2
3 print("=== Secret Message Encoder ===")
4 message = input("Enter your secret message: ")
5
6 print("\nOriginal message:", message)
7 print("Message length:", _____(message), "characters")
8
9 # Encoding Step 1: Reverse the message
10 reversed_msg = message[_____] # Use slicing to reverse
11 print(f"Step 1 - Reversed: {reversed_msg}")
12
13 # Encoding Step 2: Convert to uppercase
14 upper_msg = reversed_msg._____()
15 print(f"Step 2 - Uppercase: {upper_msg}")
16
17 # Encoding Step 3: Replace all spaces with asterisks
18 encoded_msg = upper_msg._____(_, _____)
19 print(f"Step 3 - Encoded: {encoded_msg}")
20

```

```

21 # Show first and last 3 characters of encoded message
22 if len(encoded_msg) >= 6:
23     preview = encoded_msg[_____] + "..." + encoded_msg[_____]
24     print(f"\nPreview: {preview}")
25 else:
26     print(f"\nShort message: {encoded_msg}")
27
28 # Decoding verification - reverse the process
29 print("\n--- Decoding Test ---")
30 # Remove asterisks and add spaces back
31 decoded = encoded_msg.replace("*", " ")
32 # Convert to lowercase
33 decoded = decoded._____( )
34 # Reverse again to get original
35 decoded = decoded[_____]
36 print(f"Decoded message: {decoded}")
37
38 # Check if decoding worked
39 if decoded.upper() == message.upper():
40     print("Encoding/Decoding successful!")
41 else:
42     print("Something went wrong!")

```

5 Part 5: Full Program Development (22 points)

Time estimate: 35 minutes

In this exercise, you will create a complete program that analyzes text and provides statistics.

Program Requirements

Your program should:

- Ask user to enter a sentence
- Count total characters (with and without spaces)
- Count how many vowels (a, e, i, o, u) are in the text
- Find the middle character(s) of the text
- Check if the sentence is a palindrome (reads same forwards and backwards)
- Display all statistics in a formatted report

Sample output:

```

=== Text Analyzer ===
Enter a sentence: A man a plan a canal Panama

--- Text Statistics ---
Original text: A man a plan a canal Panama
Length with spaces: 27 characters
Length without spaces: 21 characters

Vowel count:

```

Letter 'a' appears 10 times
 Letter 'e' appears 0 times
 Letter 'i' appears 0 times
 Letter 'o' appears 0 times
 Letter 'u' appears 0 times
 Total vowels: 10

Middle character(s): a c

Palindrome check:
 Forward: amanaplanacanalpanama
 Backward: amanaplanacanalpanama
 Is palindrome? YES!

Starter Structure:

Open [week4_ex5.py](#) and complete the text analyzer program.

```

1 print("=== Text Analyzer ===")
2
3 # Step 1: Get user input
4 text = input("Enter a sentence: ")
5
6 print("\n--- Text Statistics ---")
7 print(f"Original text: {text}")
8
9 # Step 2: Calculate lengths
10 # find out the total length of the text:
11 total_length = -----
12 no_spaces = text.replace(" ", "")
13 # Calculate length without spaces:
14 no_spaces_length = -----
15
16 print(f"Length with spaces: {total_length} characters")
17 print(f"Length without spaces: {no_spaces_length} characters")
18
19 # Step 3: Count vowels
20 print("\nVowel count:")
21 text_lower = text.lower()
22 total_vowels = 0
23
24 # Count each vowel (a, e, i, o, u)
25 vowels = "aeiou"
26 for vowel in vowels:
27     # Use count() method
28     count = -----
29     print(f"Letter '{vowel}' appears {count} times")
30     total_vowels = total_vowels + count
31
32 print(f"Total vowels: {total_vowels}")
33
34 # Step 4: Find middle character(s)
35 print("\nMiddle character(s): ", end="")
36 middle_index = len(text) // 2
37 if len(text) % 2 == 0:
38     # Even length: show two middle characters, Use slicing
39     middle_chars = -----
40 else:
41     # Odd length: show one middle character, Use indexing
    
```

```

42     middle_chars = -----
43 print(middle_chars)
44
45 # Step 5: Check if palindrome
46 print("\nPalindrome check:")
47 # Remove spaces and convert to lowercase for checking:
48 clean_text = -----
49 # Reverse the cleaned text:
50 reversed_text = -----
51
52 print(f"Forward: {clean_text}")
53 print(f"Backward: {reversed_text}")
54
55 if clean_text == reversed_text:
56     print("Is palindrome? YES!")
57 else:
58     print("Is palindrome? NO")

```

Testing Checklist:

- ☐ Program runs without errors
- ☐ Correctly counts characters with and without spaces
- ☐ Accurately counts all vowels
- ☐ Finds correct middle character(s)
- ☐ Palindrome check works properly
- ☐ Handles both uppercase and lowercase input

6 Part 6: Debug Detective (12 points)

Time estimate: 20 minutes

Each code snippet has issues. Find and fix them all:

6.1 Snippet 1: Name Formatter (4 points)

Open [week4_ex6.1.py](#) and fix the code that formats a name.

```

1 # Should print "Hello, AHMED!"
2 name = "ahmed"
3 greeting = "Hello, " + name.upper + "!"
4 print(greeting)

```

6.2 Snippet 2: String Slicer (4 points)

Open [week4_ex6.2.py](#) and fix the code that extracts parts of text.

```

1 # Should print first 3 and last 2 characters
2 word = "PYTHON"
3 first_part = word[3] # Wrong! This gets one character
4 last_part = word[-2] # Wrong! This gets one character
5 print(first_part + last_part)

```


6.3 Snippet 3: Character Counter (4 points)

Open [week4_ex6.3.py](#) and fix the code that counts characters.

```

1 # Should count how many times 'a' appears
2 sentence = "An apple a day keeps the doctor away"
3 count = 0
4 for char in sentence:
5     if char = "a": # Syntax error!
6         count + 1 # Logic error!
7 print(f"Found 'a' {count} times")

```

7 Part 7: Reflection Questions (5 points)

Time estimate: 10 minutes

Answer these questions in complete sentences:

1. String indexing starts at 0, and the last character is at index length-1. Why is it important to remember this when working with strings?

2. When you use a string method like `upper()`, it returns a new string rather than changing the original. Why do you think Python works this way?

3. Which string operation did you find most useful in this homework: indexing, slicing, or methods? Give a specific example of when you would use it.

8 Bonus Section: Extra Challenges (Optional - 10 extra points)

Only attempt if you've finished everything else!

8.1 Challenge 1: Word Scrambler (5 points)

Create a program that scrambles words while keeping first and last letters in place:

- Input: "Python"
- Keep 'P' at start and 'n' at end
- Reverse the middle letters: "ytho" becomes "ohty"
- Output: "Pohtyn"

The program should work for any word with 3+ letters.

Save this code as [week4_ex8_1.py](#)

8.2 Challenge 2: Text Pattern Finder (5 points)

Create a program that finds all positions where a pattern appears in text:

- Ask user for a text string
- Ask user for a pattern to find
- Use a loop to check each possible position
- Report all positions where the pattern starts
- Example: Finding "an" in "banana" gives positions 1 and 3

Save this code as [week4_ex8_2.py](#)

Submission Checklist

Before submitting, make sure you have:

- ☐ Completed all required sections
- ☐ Saved each code exercise in its own file
- ☐ Tested each code file individually to ensure it runs without errors
- ☐ Written your name at the top of this paper
- ☐ Answered all reflection questions
- ☐ Attempted bonus section (optional)
- ☐ Compressed all your code files into a single zip file named [week4_hw.zip](#)

Time Tracking:

How long did this homework take you? _____ hours

Parent/Guardian Signature: _____

(Confirming student completed work independently)

Great work mastering string basics!

Next week: String immutability and memory diagrams